



WEEKEND TALKIES

This weekend, we got y'all two magic pops for films, that'll explode little rushes in you. Except these won't leave you with unchewable candy bits.

Chintu ka Birthday Hindi, Drama, 2019

Chintu is the John of Indian nicknames, there's always one in any room. Chintu ka birthday is set in an Indian household stuck in war-borne Iraq. Now obviously one would think it narrates around the heavy duty issues. Psych, it's actually centered around a 6 year old's birthday. The movie touches on several overbearing primal issues like war damage, obsolete occupations, hostage trauma, baking a cake without an oven, mental toll on three generation families, with so much warmth and snug, that it feels like an hour long hug. Good heavens! The performances are as poignant as mid-winter melancholy. They make you mute an entire war in the background to focus on how empathy can bring as much glory when it's not selective. Maybe that's why this war-set film makes you feel safer than ever.

Ayyappanum Koshiyum Malayalam, Drama/Action, 2020

This plot is led by a single event of misbehaviour between a cop and a retired soldier. But the movie is simply an extension of Ayyapan and Koshi's Male ego and sensibility. Strangely, for a movie that follows the unfolding of a single event for 3 hours, it doesn't let you off the hook for one candid moment. Goes to say nothing can arrest human attention like the unravel of human behaviour.

As most Malayalam movies go, this one too banks on loose thread of a story and winds it tightly around surreal performances. It's as if their grand literacy rate is almost obvious from the emotional intelligence their movies reek of.

Like horror movies, this movie about the male psyche also leaves you with a strange sense of relief. This one even goes beyond and brings in hope subtle as April rain. And for the last cherry, the foothills scenery will fold up your cabin fever from the past months and throw it far far away.